DADC

المعهد الهندي للتكنولوجيا دلهي أبوظبي
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY DELHI ABU DHABI

SHORT FILM FESTIVAL 2026

OFFICIAL GUIDELINES

THE DIGITAL ARTS AND DESIGN CLUB IS PROUD TO ANNOUNCE ITS SHORT FILM FESTIVAL

OPEN TO UNIVERSITIES FROM ACROSS THE UAE AND INDIA.

ELIGIBILITY

- Each team may have between 1 and 5 core members.*
- All members must be currently enrolled at a university in the UAE or India.
- The festival is open to undergraduate students only.
- The film must have been made in 2026.

SPECIFICATIONS

LANGUAGE

Any language. Non-English films need burned-in English subtitles.

RUNTIME

3 to 15 minutes, including credits.

FORMAT

.MP4 / .MOV

RESOLUTION

Minimum 1080p, up to 4K, Landscape.

SUBMISSION

- **Film Link.** A Google Drive link to your final film, set to "Anyone with the link" and kept live until the festival ends.
- **Docket.** One to two pages: a synopsis of your film (max 200 words) and any notes on your process or creative choices.
- **Naming.** File name must be of the format ‘FilmTitle_TeamLead.mp4’

*Actors and extras outside the core team are not included in the limit of 5.

RULES & REGULATIONS

AI USE

1. AI is allowed. It is a tool, nothing more. Used well, it counts for you. Used badly, it drags the whole film down.

2. Declare all AI use on the entry form: the tool, and what it was used for.

Undeclared AI use disqualifies the film.

CONTENT STANDARDS

1. Respect all faiths and religious symbols.
2. Respect the UAE, India and all nations, their symbols and institutions.
3. No hate, extremism or discrimination.
4. No sexual content, nudity, or graphic violence.
5. Profanity only where essential to the story.
6. Films that show smoking, alcohol, drug use, violence or other mature themes must carry an age advisory (15+ or 18+) and a disclaimer.

DATES

CALL FOR ENTRIES OPENS	FINAL SUBMISSION DEADLINE	SELECTION ANNOUNCEMENT	SCREENING AND AWARDS CEREMONY
9 - 23 Oct	29 Oct	1 Nov	5 Nov

SUBMISSION FORMS CLOSE AT 23:59 GST ON DEADLINE DAY

THEME

‘GRAVITY’

Some things are drawn together. Some are held in place. Some drift for a long time before they finally fall. It isn’t always something you can see, but it’s always there, quietly shaping where things end up.

Open to every interpretation, literal or abstract.

TERMS & CONDITIONS

1. **Originality.** Entries must be the original work of the submitting team.
2. **Materials.** All music, footage, images, fonts and artwork must be original, royalty-free, licensed, or used with written permission. Proof may be requested.
3. **Consent.** Teams must have permission from everyone who appears on screen to film them and screen the film publicly.
4. **Copyright.** Copyright remains with the filmmakers.
5. **Licence.** By submitting, the team grants IIT Delhi - Abu Dhabi a non-exclusive, royalty-free licence to:
   (a) screen the film at the festival;
   (b) use excerpts of up to 60 seconds, posters and stills for promotion;
   (c) keep an archive copy for non-commercial, educational use.
6. **Liability.** The submitting team is solely responsible for any copyright or legal claims arising from its film.

REGISTRATION

- Scan the QR code to register your team
- Registered teams get the submission link one week before the deadline.

AWARDS

BEST FILM
6,000 AED

BEST STORYTELLING
1,000 AED

BEST CINEMATOGRAPHY
1,000 AED

BEST SOUND
1,000 AED

BEST POST - PRODUCTION
1,000 AED

BEST ACTOR
1,000 AED

AUDIENCE CHOICE

CONTACT

For questions, contact Karthik Nambiar, Club Secretary
at +971 562444805

The festival will feature a live screening of the shortlisted films, followed by an awards ceremony. Provisions will be made for teams based outside the UAE to join virtually.